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Irrigation channel, canal

1.1.12 Irrigation channel, canal

References:

Hebrew יְאֹר (y’or) EXO 7:19, EXO 8:1

Hebrew נָהָר (nahar) ISA 19:6

Greek διῶρυξ (diōrux) SIR 24:30, SIR 24:31

Greek ὑδραγωγός (udragōgos) SIR 24:30

Description and usage:

An irrigation channel that runs down from Wadi Kelt to Jericho (© Bukvoed, CC BY 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons)The irrigation canal was a small channel cut into the rock or dug into the ground to transfer water from a larger source such as a river into a cultivated plot of ground. The reference in SIR 24:30 gives a good description of its function: "an irrigation canal bringing water from a river into a garden" (GNT). Gardens could be watered by a system of smaller channels running off a larger channel and feeding into all parts of the garden, using gravity to deliver the water.

Translation:

The Hebrew word *y'or* normally refers to the Nile River. However, most translations agree that in EXO 7:19 and EXO 8:5 (1) it means "irrigation canal." Similarly, the Hebrew word *nahar* normally means "river," but in ISA 19:6, where it is plural in Hebrew, most translation render it "canals" (RSV) or "channels" (NJPSV).